illustrates or follows from the first. Never use a colon after a sentence fragment.

- ❖ to introduce a list
- ❖ before a quotation, and sometimes before direct speech

i) Uses of Apostrophe:

- ❖ in the possessive forms of nouns before the letter 's' when the words do not end in 's' and after the letter s, when the nouns end in 's'
- ❖ in contracted forms, in place of the letter that is left out

j) Uses of Quotation Mark or Inverted Commas:

- ❖ to enclose the words of a speaker verbatim in direct speech
- ❖ with titles of minor works and parts of whole
- ❖ around words and phrases to indicate a special sense of use or being misused
- ❖ purposely or ironically
- ❖ for the translation of a foreign word or phrase

k) Uses of hyphen:

- ❖ to join words or parts of words
- ❖ in a compound word, where two words work together to function as one adjective before the noun they describe
- ❖ in a compound word, when a noun or adjective and a present participle is combined
- ❖ in a compound word with a noun and past participle
- ❖ in numbers between twenty-one and ninety-nine, when they are written in words
- ❖ in compound adjectives with fractions (e.g. one-third / quarter-million / half-boiled)
- ❖ with prefixes ex- , self-, all- (e.g. ex-minister / self-satisfied / all-over)
- ❖ in compound adjectives using high and low (e.g. high-level, low-tide)

l) Uses of Dash: (the dash is longer than hyphen)

- ❖ to set off a word or phrase after an independent clause or a parenthetical remark (words, phrases, or clauses that interrupt a sentence)
- ❖ to signal an abrupt change in tone and to introduce or emphasize information
- ❖ to set off a series within a phrase
- ❖ before attribution to an author or composer in some formats
- ❖ after datelines
- ❖ to start lists
- ❖ to indicate hesitation in speech

Quotable Quote

"A Dash is a mark of separation stronger than a comma, less formal than a colon, and more relaxed than parentheses."

William Strunk Jr. & E.B. White

m) Uses of Parentheses or Round Brackets:

- ❖ within a sentence to provide supplementary or additional information, not essential to the main point

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